

Web watch

Turn over to our Web Watch section to see how social networking has evolved in today's day and age

App watch

Indian app developers have been busy! flip over to our App Watch section to see what's new in the Indian app scene!

Smartphone Wars!

While others try to find a way around Smartphone addiction



Windows and Android are at it, again

NoPhone?

A group of inventors from New York have launched a NoPhone on Kickstarter to beat your smartphone addiction. The device is a rectangular piece of plastic which resembles a smartphone but doesn't do anything.

The NoPhone Kickstarter page mentions features like "battery free, no upgrades necessary, shatterproof[and] waterproof." It is being touted as an ideal replacement for your pesky iPhone or Android phone. It also comes with an optional "Selfie Upgrade" (a mirror sticker). The team behind the NoPhone are aiming for \$30,000 in funding, for a phone which does nothing. This might very well be a prank from a group of friends, however it address a serious issue.

NoPhone's Kickstarter page says, "Phone addiction is real.

And it's everywhere. It's ruining your dates. It's distracting you at concerts. It's disrupting you in movie theatres. It's clogging up sidewalks. Now, there is a real solution."

They add, "The NoPhone is [a] technology-free alternative to constant hand-to-phone contact that allows you to stay connected with the real world."

Recent studies have revealed the cell phone addiction is becoming a very real problem with people. Researchers conducted a study that found that most users get nervous if separated from their smartphones for more than a few minutes. Another report released by the Bank of America stated that almost half of the Americans admit that they could not go a day without their smartphones.

Smartphone addiction counters seem to be on the rise, like the line of clothes called Focus: Life Gear by Trident was launched back in May (<http://dgit.in/focjap>). Designed by Japanese designer Kuni-hiko Morinaga, the clothing line blocks radio waves from reaching your smartphone, making it useless.

2 million Android One phones?

MediaTek is hoping over two million Android One smartphones will be sold in India this year. The Taiwan-based company has associated with Google for latter's ambitious Android One programme, aimed to deliver high quality smartphone experience on low cost devices for consumers, especially in emerging markets such as India.

"We expect 1.5-2 million Android One handsets to be sold this year in India," Mediatek VP (US business development) Mohit Bhushan told PTI. He also pointed out that the mix of software and hardware on Android One will give good experience to users. It's notable first range of Android One devices are powered by MediaTek's MT6582 SoC.

There's a lot of expectations from Google's Android One phones, and many believe it to be as successful as the Nexus smartphone line up. Under the Android One initiative, Google has tighter control on the



The NoPhone may seem like it, but it's NoJoke.